stands for the wide variety of international accords designed to limit the impact of war and to prevent the accidental outbreak of war. Under arms limitations there can be infinite measures such as the installation of fail–safe devices designed to detonate nuclear missiles in midair, should they be fired accidentally, hot lines to keep the key decision-makers in constant contact during crises, moratoriums on specific types of nuclear testing and agreements between two or more countries restricting the sale of arms and the transfer of nuclear technology.[4]

According to Schleicher, arms control is used to “include any kind of cooperation with respect to armament which could curtail the arms race, reduce the probability of war, or limit its scope and violence”.[5]

In the views of Kegley and Wittkopf[6], arms control means “cooperative agreements between states designed to regulate arms levels either by limiting their growth or by placing restrictions on how they might be used. Arms control is less ambitious than disarmament, since it seeks not to eliminate weapons but to regulate their use or moderate the pace at which they are developed”.

Since the First World War, efforts towards disarmament and arms control have been made by the world leaders to save humanity. US President Woodrow Wilson in his **Fourteen Points** upheld the need for abolition of arms and ammunitions. He also stated that armament should be reduced to “the lowest point consistent with domestic safety”. Even the **Treaty of Versailles** (1919), concluded at the end of the First World War specified that: “the maintenance of peace requires the reduction of national armaments to the lowest point consistent with national safety and the enforcement by common action of international obligations”. Under the League of Nations too, efforts were made to curb arms build-up. A Temporary Mixed Commission was set up in 1921 followed by a Preparatory Commission in 1925 on the issue of disarmament but these commissions failed to deliver the goods.

However, a landmark development towards disarmament was seen in 1925, namely, the Geneva Protocol for the Prohibition of the Use in War of Asphyxiating, Poisonous or Other Gases, and of Bacteriological Methods of Warfare. The parties to the Protocol